The Creative Hotline — Internal Data Addendum

Compiled: March 5, 2026 Supplement to: Ads Specialist Intelligence Brief

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CRITICAL CONTEXT: PRE-LAUNCH STATUS

The Creative Hotline is pre-launch. All systems are built, connected, and healthy — but there are no completed customer transactions yet. This fundamentally shapes the ads strategy.

What This Means for the Ads Specialist

1. **No historical conversion data** — can't optimize for "purchase" events initially
2. **No customer list for lookalike audiences** — must rely on interest targeting first
3. **No testimonials from paying clients** — social proof must come from credibility signals (Nike, Sony logos) and the founders' track records
4. **No organic content history** — can't identify top performers to boost
5. **All infrastructure is ready** — ManyChat, Stripe, Calendly, Notion CRM are wired up and waiting

This is actually a clean-slate advantage: the ads specialist can architect tracking and attribution from day one with zero legacy mess.

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1. STRIPE (Revenue & Payments)

Metric	Value
API Status	Connected & healthy
Completed transactions	0
Payment intents created	2 (both $499, both incomplete — test transactions)
Refunds	0
Products configured	First Call ($499), Single Call ($699), 3-Session Clarity Sprint ($1,495)

What the Ads Specialist Needs to Know

- Stripe is set up as a payment processor connected through Calendly's booking flow
- Checkout sessions are created when users reach the booking page
- 2 incomplete payment intents at $499 suggest the booking flow has been tested but no real customer has completed payment
- **Revenue tracking is ready** — Stripe events will feed into Notion CRM automatically via n8n workflows
- **Refund policy** needs to be defined and communicated in ad landing pages

Unit Economics to Model (Pre-Revenue)

Product	Price	Estimated CPA Target	Break-even ROAS
First Call	$499	$80-$150	3.3:1 - 6.2:1
Single Call	$699	$100-$200	3.5:1 - 7.0:1
Clarity Sprint	$1,495	$150-$350	4.3:1 - 10.0:1

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2. NOTION CRM (Client Pipeline)

Metric	Value
API Status	Connected & healthy
Total records	2 (1 test payment by Jake, 1 Laylo test record)
Real customers	0

Pipeline Status Breakdown

Status	Count
Lead - Laylo	1 (test record)
Paid - Needs Booking	1 (Jake's own test)
Booked - Needs Intake	0
Intake Complete	0
Ready for Call	0
Call Complete	0
Follow-Up Sent	0

CRM Schema Ready for Attribution

The CRM has the following tracking fields ready:

- **Lead Source** (select): IG DM, IG Comment, IG Story, Meta Ad, LinkedIn, Website, Referral, Direct
- **Product Purchased** (select): First Call, Single Call, 3-Session Clarity Sprint
- **Payment Date**, **Call Date** — for time-to-convert analysis
- **Booking Reminder Sent**, **Intake Reminder Sent**, **Nurture Email Sent** — for automation tracking
- **Stripe Session ID** — for revenue reconciliation

For the ads specialist: When setting up UTM parameters, map them to the "Lead Source" field. The value "Meta Ad" is already a configured option. Consider adding "Meta Ad - Cold", "Meta Ad - Retarget" as custom sources for campaign-level attribution.

Intake DB (Pre-Call Questionnaire)

Metric	Value
Total intakes	8 (4 with real data, 4 empty/test)

Intake records with data (likely demos/tests):

Client	Desired Outcomes	Creative Emergency (excerpt)
Priya Malhotra	Clear decision, Short action plan	"Launching new product tier in 3 weeks, no idea how to..."
Sarah Chen	Stronger positioning, Direction I can trust	"Getting asked to pitch bigger clients but positioning sounds like..."

Marcus Thompson	Short action plan, Someone to tell me the truth	"Instagram content performs great but not converting followers to..."
Jake Goble	Stronger positioning, Truth, Action plan, Direction	"Need help with my website"

Top desired outcomes across intakes:

1. "A short action plan" — 3 mentions
2. "Stronger positioning" — 3 mentions
3. "Someone to tell me the truth" — 2 mentions
4. "Direction I can trust" — 2 mentions
5. "A clear decision" — 1 mention

For the ads specialist: These desired outcomes are literal ad copy gold. The language your target audience uses to describe what they want:

- "A short action plan" → Ad hook: "Get a custom action plan in 24 hours"
- "Someone to tell me the truth" → Ad hook: "Creative direction. No BS."
- "Stronger positioning" → Ad hook: "Stop blending in. Start standing out."
- "Direction I can trust" → Ad hook: "Senior creative direction from people who've done it for Nike, Sony, and the WNBA."

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3. CALENDLY (Booking Data)

Metric	Value
API Status	Connected & healthy
Account	soscreativehotline@gmail.com
Event type	"Creative Hotline Call" — 45 min, active
Completed bookings	0
Cancelled bookings	0
Upcoming bookings	0

Booking Infrastructure

- Single event type configured: 45-minute Creative Hotline Call
- Stripe payment is gated at booking (must pay to book)
- Calendly link is sent after Stripe payment via n8n workflow (WF1)

For the ads specialist: The booking flow is: Ad → Landing Page → Stripe checkout → Calendly booking link emailed → Client books a slot. Consider whether a "Book Now" CTA should go directly to a Calendly page with embedded Stripe payment, or to a landing page first. Direct-to-Calendly reduces friction but loses the landing page's persuasion opportunity.

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4. MANYCHAT (Instagram DM Automation)

Metric	Value
API Status	Connected & healthy

Total subscribers	0
New subscribers (30d)	0

Tags Infrastructure (Pre-Built, Ready for Data)

The ManyChat account has **10 tags** already configured for sophisticated lead tracking:

Tag	Purpose	Current Count
`viewed_creative`	Saw creative/portfolio content	0
`viewed_pricing`	Looked at pricing info	0
`needs_human`	Requested human handoff	0
`booked`	Completed booking	0
`objection_timing`	Expressed timing objection	0
`objection_price`	Expressed price objection	0
`abandoned_conversation`	Started but dropped off	0
`interested_not_booked`	Showed interest, didn't book	0
`link_clicked`	Clicked a link in DM	0

Growth Tools (3 Active)

Tool	Type
Quick Automation EN	Comment-to-DM trigger
Quick Automation Story Reply	Story reply trigger
Quick Automation EN	Comment-to-DM trigger (duplicate)

Custom Fields for Ad Attribution

Field	Type	Purpose
`ad_campaign`	text	Track which ad campaign drove the DM
`ad_source`	text	Track ad source/medium
`first_touch_date`	datetime	Record first interaction date

For the ads specialist: This is a sophisticated ManyChat setup ready for ad campaigns. Key implications:

1. **Objection tracking is built in** — when people say "too expensive" or "not the right time", they get tagged. This data will reveal the most common objections to address in ad copy.
2. **Ad attribution is ready** — the `ad_campaign` and `ad_source` custom fields mean you can track which specific ad drove each DM subscriber. Set UTM → ManyChat field mapping from day one.

3. **Comment-to-DM automations are active** — Reels ads with "Comment [KEYWORD]" CTAs will trigger automated DM sequences immediately.
4. **The `interested_not_booked` tag** is your retargeting goldmine — these are warm leads who engaged but didn't convert. Build a custom audience from this segment.

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5. WHAT'S MISSING & NEEDS TO BE SET UP

Before Running Ads (Blocking)

- [ ] **Meta Pixel + CAPI**: Confirm the pixel is firing on all booking flow pages (website scan shows it's installed, but verify events are tracking: PageView, InitiateCheckout, Purchase)
- [ ] **Custom conversions**: Create in Meta Events Manager for: ViewContent (pricing page), InitiateCheckout (Stripe page), Purchase (booking confirmed)
- [ ] **UTM conventions**: Define standard UTM parameters across all ad campaigns (e.g., `utm_source=meta&utm_medium=paid&utm_campaign=cold_v1&utm_content=reel_skip_agency`)
- [ ] **Landing page**: The current website serves as the landing page but has no dedicated ad-specific LP. Consider creating a stripped-down version focused solely on conversion
- [ ] **First 3-5 ad creatives produced**: Video of Jake/Megha talking to camera, at minimum

Before Scaling (Important but Not Blocking)

- [ ] **Video testimonials**: Need at least 1-2 client testimonials before scaling spend (first customers are critical)
- [ ] **Lead magnet**: No email capture exists — build one for the secondary funnel (e.g., "5-Minute Brand Audit" checklist)
- [ ] **Email nurture sequence**: 3-5 email series for leads who download lead magnet but don't book immediately
- [ ] **Google Analytics 4**: Verify it's configured with the same conversion events as Meta Pixel
- [ ] **Retargeting audiences**: Build and let them populate for 2-4 weeks before running retargeting campaigns

Data Collection Priorities (First 30 Days)

Once ads are running, track and report weekly:

Metric	Source	Why It Matters
CPM & CPC by ad	Meta Ads Manager	Creative performance
CTR by ad	Meta Ads Manager	Hook effectiveness
Landing page conversion rate	GA4	Page optimization
DM-to-booking rate	ManyChat + Notion	Funnel efficiency
Objection tag distribution	ManyChat	Ad copy refinement
Cost per booking	Meta + Stripe	True CPA
Lead source distribution	Notion CRM	Channel ROI
Time from first touch to purchase	ManyChat + Stripe	Sales cycle length

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6. LAUNCH STRATEGY ADJUSTMENT (Pre-Revenue)

Given the pre-launch status, the original brief's strategy needs modification:

Phase 0: Organic Foundation (Weeks 1-2, Before Paid)

- Post 10-15 organic Reels establishing Creative Hotline's presence
- Use comment-to-DM on every post to start building ManyChat subscribers
- Get 1-3 "beta clients" through personal network (discounted or free) for testimonial content
- Document the beta calls for before/after content

Phase 1: Seed Campaign (Weeks 3-4, $20-30/day)

- **Objective**: Traffic/Engagement (NOT conversions — not enough data for Meta to optimize)
- Run 2-3 Reels ads to build retargeting audiences
- Focus on video views and Instagram engagement
- Keyword CTA → ManyChat DMs → qualify manually
- **Goal**: First 5-10 paying customers + testimonials

Phase 2: Learning (Weeks 5-8, $30-50/day)

- Switch to Conversions objective once you have 10+ purchases
- Start testing audiences: interest-based vs. ManyChat subscriber LAL (if 1,000+ by then)
- Introduce retargeting with testimonial content from Phase 1 clients
- **Goal**: Identify winning creative and audience, approach break-even

Phase 3: Scale (Weeks 9+, per original brief)

- Follow the Phase 2 and 3 strategy from the original intel brief

Why This Matters

Meta's algorithm needs ~50 conversion events per ad set per week to optimize. At $499/sale, that's ~$25K/week in revenue per ad set — unrealistic at launch. Starting with engagement/traffic objectives lets the algorithm learn your audience without requiring purchase volume. Switch to conversion optimization once you have enough signal.

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7. COMPETITOR AD INTELLIGENCE

Meta Ad Library access is blocked from automated tools. The ads specialist should manually search these terms in the Meta Ad Library:

Search Queries to Run

1. "creative direction" — see who's advertising creative direction services
2. "brand strategy call" — direct competitors
3. "creative consultant" — broader competitive set
4. "fractional creative director" — emerging category
5. Search by advertiser: "The Futur", "Chris Do", "Blind", "Collins"

What to Look For

- **Ad formats**: Video vs static vs carousel
- **Hook text**: First line of ad copy
- **CTA button**: Book Now vs Learn More vs Send Message
- **Run duration**: Longer-running ads = likely profitable (keep an eye on these)
- **Landing page URL**: Where do competitors send traffic?

Competitive Gap (From Web Research)

- **Talk to a Creative Director** (talktoacreativedirector.com): Free mentorship calls — not a paid competitor but occupies mindshare
- **Chris Do / The Futur**: Sells courses and coaching memberships, NOT individual calls. Massive audience but different model
- **Clarity.fm / Intro.co**: General expert marketplaces (15-20% commission, per-minute rates). Not branded around creative direction
- **No direct competitor** is running a branded, fixed-price creative direction call service with AI-powered briefings and 24-hour action plan delivery. This is a genuine white space.

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8. KEYWORD INTELLIGENCE (For Google Ads)

Specific search volume data requires Google Keyword Planner access (the ads specialist should pull this). Based on industry data:

Estimated Search Volumes (US, Monthly)

Keyword	Est. Volume	Intent	Competition
"creative direction"	5,000-10,000	Informational (broad)	Medium
"creative consultant"	1,000-3,000	Mixed	Medium
"creative director for hire"	500-1,000	High intent	Low-Medium
"fractional creative director"	500-1,500	High intent	Low
"brand strategy session"	200-500	High intent	Low
"creative direction consultant"	100-300	Very high intent	Low
"brand strategy call"	100-200	Very high intent	Very Low
"hire creative director freelance"	100-300	High intent	Low
"creative consulting call"	<100	Very high intent	Very Low

Recommended Google Ads Priority

- Start with **exact match** on high-intent, low-competition terms
- Budget: $15-20/day initially (secondary to Meta)
- Expected CPC: $3-$12
- These are low-volume but high-intent — every click is someone actively looking for what you sell

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9. EMAIL LIST & AUDIENCE SIZE

Asset	Size	Lookalike Viable?
Customer email list	0	No (need 100+ for custom audience, 1,000+ for useful LAL)
ManyChat subscribers	0	No

Website visitors (pixel)	Unknown (pixel installed, need to check Events Manager)	Possibly, if site has had traffic
Instagram followers	Unknown (check @creative.hotline Insights)	Yes, if 1,000+

Priority action: Check Instagram Insights for @creative.hotline — follower count, demographics, and engagement rate. If there's an existing organic audience, that's the first retargeting/LAL seed.

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10. REVENUE MODELING

Path to $800K Revenue Goal

Scenario	Product Mix	Clients Needed	Clients/Month (12mo)	Ad Budget Needed
All First Call ($499)	100% $499	1,603	134/mo	$13K-$20K/mo
All Single Call ($699)	100% $699	1,144	96/mo	$10K-$19K/mo
All Sprint ($1,495)	100% $1,495	535	45/mo	$7K-$16K/mo
Realistic Mix	50% FC, 30% SC, 20% Sprint	**~950**	**~80/mo**	**$8K-$16K/mo**

Realistic Mix Breakdown

- 475 First Call clients x $499 = $236,975
- 285 Single Call clients x $699 = $199,215
- 190 Sprint clients x $1,495 = $284,050
- **Total: $720,240** (add ~10% upsells/referrals to hit $800K)

Capacity Check

At 80 clients/month and 45 minutes/call:

- **60 hours/month of call time** (15 hours/week)
- Plus prep time (AI briefing handles most of this)
- Plus action plan delivery (within 24 hours)
- **This is tight for 1-2 people** — the Sprint clients take 3 calls each

Recommendation for ads specialist: Start with First Call ($499) as the primary advertised offer. It's the lowest barrier and builds the client base fastest. Upsell to Sprint during or after the first call.

APPENDIX: Raw Data Files

- `docs/ads-internal-data.json` — Full JSON output from API extraction
- `docs/ads-specialist-intel-brief.md` — Primary strategy brief
- `docs/ads-specialist-intel-brief.pdf` — PDF version of strategy brief
- `scripts/ads_data_extract.py` — Reusable script to pull fresh data

To refresh data after launch:

```
cd /Users/bronteruiz/Projects/creative-hotline
python3 scripts/ads_data_extract.py
```

SOURCES

- Live API queries: Stripe, Notion, Calendly, ManyChat (March 5, 2026)
- Meta Ad Library (manual search recommended)
- Google Keyword Planner (manual lookup recommended)
- Fractional Work Statistics 2026
- ManyChat DM vs Email Performance
- Consulting Fees & Pricing 2026
- Search Engine Land: Facebook Ad Templates 2026
- Facebook Ads for Coaches Guide